

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 42)

Page 207 - Cobbett, Landor, Southey, Coleridge

Q1. Which book is considered William Cobbett's most characteristic and of most permanent interest?

- A. Imaginary Conversations
- B. Rural Rides
- C. English Grammar
- D. The Pentameron

Answer: B

Q2. Why is Cobbett's 'English Grammar' considered unique among grammars?

- A. It is written entirely in verse
- B. It is thoroughly entertaining
- C. It includes no rules
- D. It is written in broad Scotch

Answer: B

Q3. Who is presented as an antithesis to Cobbett in almost every conceivable particular?

- A. Walter Savage Landor
- B. Robert Southey
- C. Samuel Taylor Coleridge
- D. Thomas De Quincey

Answer: A

Q4. Landor is unsurpassed in which style of prose writing?

- A. Vernacular and colloquial
- B. Severe, sententious, sculpturesque
- C. Passionate and rhetorical
- D. Easy-going and irresponsible

Answer: B

Q5. What is the title of Landor's principal prose work consisting of dialogues between great characters of the past?

- A. Rural Rides
- B. Biographia Literaria
- C. Imaginary Conversations
- D. Peter Plymley's Letters

Answer: C

Q6. Which of the following works is a tale of the golden age of Athens told in letters by Landor?

- A. The Citation of William Shakespeare
- B. The Pentameron
- C. Pericles and Aspasia
- D. Life of Nelson

Answer: C

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Q7. The 'Pentameron' is a series of dialogues between which two historical figures?

- A. Pericles and Aspasia
- B. Petrarch and Boccaccio
- C. Dante and Beatrice
- D. Shakespeare and Jonson

Answer: B

Q8. What is Robert Southey's prose masterpiece?

- A. Life of Scott
- B. Life of Nelson
- C. Rural Rides
- D. Biographia Literaria

Answer: B

Q9. Which prose work by Coleridge is rambling and unequal but contains profound analytical and interpretative power?

- A. Imaginary Conversations
- B. Rural Rides
- C. Biographia Literaria
- D. Table Talk

Answer: C

Q10. What effect did Coleridge's criticism have?

- A. It established the classical principle in literature
- B. It exercised a profound influence in the establishment of the romantic principle
- C. It destroyed the romantic movement
- D. It revived medieval drama

Answer: B

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Page 208 - The Age of Wordsworth: Historians and Philosophers

Q1. The text notes that this chapter could be extended considerably by the inclusion of writers in which fields?

- A. Science and mathematics
- B. History and philosophy
- C. Astronomy and geography
- D. Law and medicine

Answer: B

Q2. During the period discussed, many writers did excellent work in history and philosophy. How does the author choose to handle them?

- A. By providing a detailed catalogue of their names
- B. By analyzing their major works in depth
- C. By excluding them from discussion here
- D. By devoting a separate chapter to them

Answer: C

Q3. What reason does the author give for not discussing the historical and philosophical writers?

- A. Their works are lost
- B. This is not the place to discuss the value of their contributions to their special subjects
- C. They are not considered part of English literature
- D. Their works were written in Latin

Answer: B

Q4. How does the author view a 'mere catalogue of their names and writings'?

- A. As highly beneficial to students
- B. As a necessary evil
- C. As serving no useful purpose
- D. As the best way to summarize the era

Answer: C

Q5. The omission of historians and philosophers indicates the book's primary focus is on:

- A. General literature (poetry, fiction, essays, criticism)
- B. Political theory
- C. Hard sciences
- D. Theological debates

Answer: A

Q6. The decision not to list the philosophers and historians is a matter of:

- A. Ignorance
- B. Space constraints and narrative focus
- C. Censorship
- D. Academic disagreement

Answer: B

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Q7. While the romantic era produced great poetry and essays, it is implied that it also produced substantial work in:

- A. Greek drama
- B. History and philosophy
- C. Modern physics
- D. Classical sculpture

Answer: B

Q8. The phrase 'contributions to the literature of their special subjects' suggests that:

- A. Their writing is only technical
- B. They are important in their fields but may not belong in a general literary history
- C. They were bad writers
- D. They were mostly novelists in disguise

Answer: B

Q9. The author skips these writers to maintain the flow of the book towards which upcoming topic in the next chapter?

- A. The Augustan Age
- B. The Novel in the Age of Wordsworth
- C. The Victorian Drama
- D. The Renaissance

Answer: B

Q10. By omitting a 'mere catalogue', the author emphasizes that this outline history is:

- A. A complete encyclopedia
- B. An interpretative overview rather than a dry list of facts
- C. A political manifesto
- D. A scientific text

Answer: B

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Page 209 - The Age of Wordsworth: The Novel and Scott

Q1. Chapter 21 focuses on which literary form during the Age of Wordsworth?

- A. The Epic Poem
- B. The Essay
- C. The Novel
- D. The Drama

Answer: C

Q2. For how long did Sir Walter Scott enjoy great success as a writer of romances in verse before turning to prose fiction?

- A. Five years
- B. Ten years
- C. Fifteen years
- D. Twenty years

Answer: B

Q3. Which of the following is given as a reason for Scott turning from verse to prose romance?

- A. He lost his ability to write rhyming verse
- B. The original vein he had opened up was getting exhausted
- C. The government banned verse romances
- D. He wanted to write history books instead

Answer: B

Q4. Whose sudden rise threatened the supremacy Scott had long enjoyed in poetry?

- A. Keats
- B. Shelley
- C. Wordsworth
- D. Byron

Answer: D

Q5. With which work in 1814 did Scott strike out definitely into a new line of prose fiction?

- A. Rokeby
- B. Waverley
- C. The Lay of the Last Minstrel
- D. The Lady of the Lake

Answer: B

Q6. Which of Scott's later narrative poems is described as 'to all intents and purposes a novel in verse'?

- A. The Lay of the Last Minstrel
- B. Marmion
- C. Rokeby
- D. The Lord of the Isles

Answer: C

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Q7. In 'Rokeby', what did Scott perceive about the focus of the interest for the first time?

- A. It centered on character rather than incident
- B. It centered entirely on incident
- C. It was purely historical facts
- D. It was based on supernatural elements

Answer: A

Q8. How did verse function for Scott's powers when writing 'Rokeby'?

- A. As a perfect medium
- B. As an aid
- C. As a hindrance
- D. As an inspiration

Answer: C

Q9. Before writing Waverley, Scott had entertained the ambitious desire of composing a tale of chivalry in the style of which book?

- A. The Castle of Otranto
- B. Robinson Crusoe
- C. Pamela
- D. Tom Jones

Answer: A

Q10. Scott's 'The Lay of the Last Minstrel' was an elaboration of what old form?

- A. The sonnet
- B. The ballad form
- C. The epic
- D. The ode

Answer: B

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Page 210 - Scott's Transition to Prose

Q1. The reception accorded to which poem convinced Scott that there was a large English reading public interested in the Highlands?

- A. The Lay of the Last Minstrel
- B. Rokeby
- C. The Lady of the Lake
- D. Marmion

Answer: C

Q2. Whose 'Irish Tales' gave Scott a fresh stimulus to write a prose romance?

- A. Jane Austen's
- B. Fanny Burney's
- C. Maria Edgeworth's
- D. Mary Shelley's

Answer: C

Q3. What particularly struck Scott about Maria Edgeworth's Irish Tales?

- A. Their supernatural elements
- B. Their detailed pictures of the characters and manners of the Irish people
- C. Their strict classical structure
- D. Their deep philosophical digressions

Answer: B

Q4. What did Scott aim to do for Scotland inspired by Maria Edgeworth?

- A. Write epic poetry about its ancient kings
- B. What Miss Edgeworth had done for Ireland
- C. Write a comprehensive political history
- D. Create a dictionary of the Scottish dialect

Answer: B

Q5. How did Scott accidentally rediscover the draft of the first chapters of Waverley?

- A. While moving houses
- B. While hunting in a drawer for some fishing tackle
- C. A friend found it and sent it to him
- D. He found it in an old book of poetry

Answer: B

Q6. How long did it take Scott to complete Waverley after finding the draft?

- A. Three weeks
- B. Three months
- C. A year
- D. Three days

Answer: A

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Q7. Scott's work in fiction represents the amalgamation of the 18th century historical romance and what else?

- A. The 18th century essay
- B. The 18th century novel of manners
- C. The 17th century epic
- D. The Gothic horror story

Answer: B

Q8. What unique combination of interests did Waverley bring together for the first time?

- A. Romance and realism
- B. Philosophy and science
- C. Politics and economics
- D. Poetry and drama

Answer: A

Q9. What did Scott do for the story of manners for the first time?

- A. Set it in a futuristic framework
- B. Set it in an historical framework
- C. Wrote it entirely in dialect
- D. Combined it with fairy tales

Answer: B

Q10. Scott's transition to the novel merged his romantic inspiration of the past with his intimate knowledge of:

- A. Actual Scottish life
- B. Ancient Greek mythology
- C. Contemporary London society
- D. French revolutionary politics

Answer: A

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Page 211 - Characteristics of Scott's Novels

Q1. How many novels and tales make up the Waverley Novels?

- A. Twenty-seven novels and five tales
- B. Twenty novels and ten tales
- C. Thirty novels and two tales
- D. Fifteen novels and fifteen tales

Answer: A

Q2. The Waverley Novels were the result of how many years of extraordinary creative activity?

- A. Ten years
- B. Eighteen years
- C. Twenty-five years
- D. Thirty years

Answer: B

Q3. Which century does 'Count Robert of Paris' cover?

- A. Eleventh century
- B. Twelfth century
- C. Fourteenth century
- D. Fifteenth century

Answer: A

Q4. 'Ivanhoe' and 'The Talisman' are set in which century?

- A. Eleventh century
- B. Twelfth century
- C. Fourteenth century
- D. Fifteenth century

Answer: B

Q5. In which setting is Scott always at his best?

- A. Medieval England
- B. The Scotland of the 17th and 18th centuries
- C. 15th century France
- D. 11th century Byzantium

Answer: B

Q6. What is Scott's regular practice in his historical novels regarding the hero?

- A. The hero is always a famous historical king
- B. The hero is a private individual whose fortunes become involved in great public movements
- C. The hero is a mythological figure
- D. The hero never interacts with real historical events

Answer: B

Q7. In 'Waverley', the hero Edward Waverley gets entangled in which historical event?

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- A. The Wars of the Roses
- B. The Jacobite rising of 1745
- C. The French Revolution
- D. The English Civil War

Answer: B

Q8. What famous historical figure does Edward Waverley meet in the novel?

- A. Queen Elizabeth I
- B. The Young Pretender
- C. Oliver Cromwell
- D. Richard the Lionheart

Answer: B

Q9. Who noted that Scott's novels taught all men that bygone ages were filled by living men, not by abstractions?

- A. Jeffrey
- B. Hazlitt
- C. Carlyle
- D. Macaulay

Answer: C

Q10. Is Scott's treatment of history entirely accurate in his novels?

- A. Yes, he never deviates from historical facts
- B. No, he often takes great liberties with facts
- C. Yes, they are used as primary historical textbooks
- D. He only writes about fictional countries

Answer: B